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Fallback between LLMs

OpenClaw

Never run out of agents again · configure alternatives and switch models on the fly

How fallback works

When the tokens run out or the API crashes, OpenClaw automatically tries the next configured model. You can switch on the

· Anthropic

primary model

· failure ·

· Google Gemini

fallback 1

· failure ·

· OpenAI

fallback 2

· failure ·

· openclaw doctor

diagnostics

1 · Switch model via agent (main mode)

No terminal needed. Just send a message to the agent via

· Telegram

· WhatsApp

· Discord

See which model is active

· PROMPT

/model

· PROMPT

/model status

· PROMPT

Which model are you using now? Do you have available credits?

List available models

· PROMPT

/model list

Switch models on the fly

· PROMPT · SWITCH TO GEMINI

/model google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview

· PROMPT · SWITCH TO OPENAI

/model openai/gpt-5.1-codex

· PROMPT · SWITCH TO CLAUDE HAIKU (CHEAPER)

/model anthropic/claude-haiku-4-5

· PROMPT · SWITCH BY ALIAS

/model Gemini

My tokens are used up · what to do?

· PROMPT · SWITCH TO GEMINI (FREE VIA GEMINI CLI)

/model google-gemini-cli/gemini-2.5-pro

· PROMPT · REQUEST DIAGNOSTIC

My Anthropic credits are used up. Help me configure Gemini

as a fallback and switch to it now

· PROMPT · RETURN TO ORIGINAL MODEL

Return to Claude Sonnet as the main model

Configure automatic fallback via chat

· PROMPT

Configure Gemini as an automatic fallback for when Anthropic fails. Primary: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6. Fallback: google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview.

· PROMPT · CHAIN FALLBACK

I want a fallback chain: first Claude Sonnet, then Gemini

Pro, then GPT as a last resort. Help me configure this in openclaw.json.

2 · Available models (official names)

The IDs below are the exact names as per the official documentation from OpenClaw. Use these IDs in openclaw.json , in the terminal or in the prompts.

Anthropic

Claude Opus

anthropic/claude-opus-4-6

Claude Sonnet

anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6

Claude Sonnet (previous)

anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-5

Claude Haiku

anthropic/claude-haiku-4-5

Google (API Key)

Gemini 3.1 Pro

google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview

Gemini 2.5 Pro

google/gemini-2.5-pro-preview

Gemini Flash 2.0

google/gemini-flash-2.0

Gemini 3 Pro

google/gemini-3-pro-preview

Google Gemini CLI free

Gemini 2.5 Pro

google-gemini-cli/gemini-2.5-pro

Auth: OAuth plugin (no API key)

Enable: openclaw plugins enable google-gemini-cli-auth

.. Use non-critical account (unofficial)

OpenAI

GPT-5.1 Codex

openai/gpt-5.1-codex

GPT-5.2

openai/gpt-5.2

OpenAI Codex OAuth

GPT-5.3 Codex

openai-codex/gpt-5.3-codex

Auth: OAuth ChatGPT (no API key)

Officially supported by OpenAI

OpenCode Zen
Claude Opus via OpenCode
opencode/claude-opus-4-6
Auth: OPENCODE_API_KEY
Z.AI (GLM)
GLM-5
zai/glm-5
Auth: ZAI_API_KEY
MiniMax
MiniMax-01
minimax/minimax-01
1M context tokens, minimum cost
Recommended models by use case
Usage
Recommended model
Why
Main chat / day-
to-day
anthropic/claude-
sonnet-4-6
Best cost-benefit
overall
Complex tasks /
reasoning
anthropic/claude-
opus-4-6
Most powerful, larger
context
Crons and
automations
anthropic/claude-
haiku-4-5
~95% cheaper,
sufficient
Default fallback
google/gemini-3.1-pro-
preview
Advanced reasoning,
good alternative
No money /
free
google-gemini-cli/
gemini-2.5-pro
OAuth without API key
(Google account)
Long context (1M
tokens)
google/gemini-2.5-pro-
preview
Best for huge
files

Usage

Recommended model

Why

Minimum cost +

volume

minimax/minimax-01

1M tokens, extremely

low price

3 ·· Configure fallback in openclaw.json

This configuration ensures that if a model fails, OpenClaw automatically tries the next one · without you needing to do anything

Basic configuration with fallback

// ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json

```
{
  agents: {
    defaults: {
      model: {
        primary: "anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6",
        fallbacks: [
          "google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview",
          "openai/gpt-5.1-codex"
        ]
      }
    }
  }
}
```

With aliases (friendly names) and allowlist

```
{
  agents: {
    defaults: {
      model: {
        primary: "anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6",
        fallbacks: [
          "google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview",
```

```
"openai/gpt-5.1-codex"
```

```
]
```

```
},
```

```
models: {
```

```
"anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6": { alias: "Sonnet" },
```

```
"anthropic/claude-opus-4-6": { alias: "Opus" },
```

```
"anthropic/claude-haiku-4-5": { alias: "Haiku" },
```

```
"google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview": { alias: "Gemini" },
```

```
"openai/gpt-5.1-codex": { alias: "GPT" }
```

```
}
```

```
}
```

```
}
```

```
}
```

CLI commands to manage fallbacks

View current model and configured fallbacks

```
openclaw models status
```

List all available models

```
openclaw models list
```

Change primary model

```
openclaw models set anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6
```

Add fallback

```
openclaw models fallbacks add google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview
```

List fallbacks

```
openclaw models fallbacks list
```

Remove fallback

```
openclaw models fallbacks remove openai/gpt-5.1-codex
```

Clear all fallbacks

```
openclaw models fallbacks clear
```

Add alias (friendly name)

```
openclaw models aliases add Gemini google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview
```

Configure via config set (without editing file)
Define primary model via command line
openclaw config set agents.defaults.model.primary "anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6"
See the active config
openclaw config get agents.defaults.model
4 · Add credentials for new providers
Anthropic (API key)
openclaw onboard --auth-choice anthropic-api-key
Or paste directly:
openclaw models auth paste-token \
--provider anthropic
Google Gemini (API key)
openclaw onboard --auth-choice gemini
Or via environment variable:
export GEMINI_API_KEY=your_key
OpenAI (API key)
openclaw onboard --auth-choice openai-api-key
Gemini CLI (free, OAuth)
openclaw plugins enable google-gemini-cl
openclaw models auth login \
--provider google-gemini-cli \
--set-default
.. The Gemini CLI OAuth is an unofficial integration. Use a non-critical
Google account. Google may restrict accounts that use third-party clients.
Save credentials via prompt
· PROMPT

Save this Google Gemini API key in 1Password with the name "Gemini API Key - OpenClaw" and configure it as a fallback:

5 · openclaw doctor · diagnosis and correction

Symptoms that you need the doctor: agent doesn't respond,
model error, gateway offline, corrupted configuration after changing
LLM.

Via agent (easier)

· PROMPT · BASIC DIAGNOSIS

Run openclaw doctor and tell me what you found

· PROMPT · WITH AUTOMATIC CORRECTION

Run openclaw doctor --fix and fix the problems found

· PROMPT · DEEP SCAN

Do a complete system scan with openclaw doctor --
deep --fix

Via terminal

· Doctor Commands

Basic health check

openclaw doctor

Check and apply recommended fixes

openclaw doctor --fix

Deep system scan

openclaw doctor --deep
Deep correction without confirmations (automatic)
openclaw doctor --deep --fix --yes
Forced correction (overwrites custom settings)
openclaw doctor --fix --force
Regenerate gateway token if lost
openclaw doctor --generate-gateway-token
Non-interactive mode (for scripts/automation)
openclaw doctor --fix --non-interactive
When to use each command
Problem
Command
Agent doesn't respond after changing
LLM
openclaw doctor --fix
Gateway offline
openclaw doctor --deep --fix
Corrupted / invalid config
openclaw doctor --fix --yes
"model not allowed" error after
change
openclaw doctor --fix + verify
allowlist
Gateway token disappeared
openclaw doctor --generate-gateway-
token
Everything is broken, I want a total reset
openclaw doctor --deep --fix --
force --yes
Validate the config before applying
Validates openclaw.json without restarting the gateway
openclaw config validate

Ver o caminho do arquivo de config ativo

openclaw config file

6 · Fluxo de emergência: tokens acabaram

Se os créditos do Anthropic acabarem e você não tiver outro modelo configurado, o agente para de responder. Siga esse fluxo para resolver via terminal.

Passo 1: Verificar o status atual

openclaw models status

Passo 2: Adicionar Gemini como fallback imediato

openclaw models fallbacks add google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview

Passo 3: Trocar o primário para Gemini agora

openclaw models set google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview

Passo 4: Reiniciar o gateway para aplicar

openclaw gateway restart

Passo 5: Verificar se está funcionando

openclaw doctor

Opção grátis: Gemini CLI (sem API key)

Ativar plugin do Gemini CLI

openclaw plugins enable google-gemini-cli-auth

Fazer login com conta Google (abre navegador)

openclaw models auth login --provider google-gemini-cli --set-default

Trocar pra Gemini CLI

openclaw models set google-gemini-cli/gemini-2.5-pro

Restart

openclaw gateway restart

· To avoid this situation: configure fallbacks before you need them. OpenClaw will automatically switch when it detects that t

7 · Quick reference · essential commands

Action

Terminal

Via chat

View active

model

openclaw models status

/model status

List models

openclaw models list

/model list

Change model

openclaw models set

provider/model

/model provider/

model

Add fallback

openclaw models fallbacks

add provider/model

Ask the agent in

natural language

Diagnosis

openclaw doctor

Ask the agent to run

doctor

Automatic

correction

openclaw doctor --fix

Ask the agent to run

with --fix

Validate config

openclaw config validate

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Restart

gateway

openclaw gateway restart

Ask the agent to restart

the gateway

Official IDs · quick paste

Anthropic

anthropic/claude-opus-4-6

most powerful

anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6

recommended for everyday use

anthropic/claude-haiku-4-5
cheaper
Google (API key)
google/gemini-3.1-pro-preview
main fallback
google/gemini-2.5-pro-preview
1M tokens context
google/gemini-flash-2.0
faster/cheaper
Free Google (OAuth, no API key)
google-gemini-cli/gemini-2.5-pro
emergency with no credits
OpenAI
openai/gpt-5.1-codex
API key
openai-codex/gpt-5.3-codex
OAuth ChatGPT
Others
opencode/claude-opus-4-6
Claude via OpenCode Zen
zai/glm-5
Z.AI GLM
minimax/minimax-01
minimum cost, long context
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